

U.S. Dollar Stores

Back in the Bargain Bin

Dollar store stocks have pulled back recently for a variety of reasons that we detail below. We also caught up with DG and DLTR management recently. Competitive concerns will likely linger but the pullback seems overdone.

What's new: DG and DLTR sold off on Friday (-4.5%/-3.1% vs XLP -0.2%) on the back of Amazon partnering with Winn Dixie, following several other recent announcements signaling a bigger grocery push. Consumables account for ~80% of DG business and ~50% for DLTR. This comes at a time when same-day delivery seems to be ramping broadly across our space. This news also coincides with somewhat of a seasonal lull following back to school (mainly for gen merch), incl DLTR decelerating QTD to around +4% as of the Q2 call. This has led to questions about elasticity related to recent price increase, along with recent concerns that Temu growth has reaccelerated.

Our take: While there are ongoing competitive risks, we believe that the pullback is overdone and expect both companies to get back on algorithm in the coming quarters, due to unique margin drivers for each, and steady top-line trends. We see DG/ DLTR continuing to outperform the market as we detail below. We also see some seasonal opportunities in 2H, less noise with upcoming hurricane/port strike compares vs. others in the space, and potentially an acceleration in "trade-in" as low-income real wage growth moderates. Ultimately, we are looking for evidence that DG can sustain comps in this ~3% range and DLTR +MSD, which would support upside to EPS for both names in FY26.

On the e-commerce concerns, the announcement does not seem as incremental for the discount retailers vs. the prevailing risk - WMT's strong delivery growth among low-income shoppers. For all of grocery, delivery is breaking down the store convenience factor (e.g. negative store volume for the grocers) while increasing price transparency. As store fulfillment enables quicker delivery everywhere, retailers can win either through assortment/in-stock/availability and/or value. It's not clear that the AMZN partnership changes the value proposition of the dollar stores (we think WMT and Aldi would be the two bigger risks to monitor).

Still gaining share? WMT's impact was the main concern last year. This is valid, as our own work confirms strong digital growth among lower-income shoppers. Yet, dollar store results have also improved over the last year, benefiting from company-specific improvements, along with share gains from other channels. For example, DG consumable comps were ~3% in Q2, below WMT's MSD but above the total market that grew <2% per NielsenIQ data, with the lower-income part of the market below that, the large grocers <2% ex. pharmacy, and the convenience and drug channels lagging that. While we do believe WMT is gaining share, we believe the dollar stores have also benefited from competitor closings and other channel shifts.

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U.S. Broadlines, Hardlines & Food Retail

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Dollar stores are starting to participate in delivery, although very early. We believe this is an opportunity. DG's digital business grew 60% in Q2 albeit off low base (we est. LSD % of sales). The company has discussed 75% of orders filled in an hour or less, which is competitive. Its white label initiative is still early, just a few months in, but seems to be ramping (which will also provide media opportunities that are key to the margin outlook). Interestingly, its average basket is tracking above its typical ~\$17 at ~\$20 on delivery services, but still seems to be below other retailers. We believe delivery is also driving an incremental customer.

Looking to 2H, we see a number of opportunities. We expect the low-income consumer to remain constrained, which should help these names. We have heard some retailers discuss more peaks and valleys around paycheck cycles recently. Inflation in goods has also accelerated, while low gas prices remain a key offset. For DG, delivery should continue to ramp (and be incremental), and we see other sales drivers (leaning into \$2 or less, remodels, assortment changes, in stock). For DLTR, we believe Q2 helped validate the upside from multi-price point, which bodes well for some key seasonal periods ahead. Trade-in should continue as well (2/3 of customer growth was >\$100k in Q2, accelerating from Q1). Pricing should also have a bigger benefit in 2H. We believe both companies are well positioned to hit their 2H comps guidance while delivering an improvement in margins.

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Materially Mentioned Stocks (Ticker, Date, Price)

Dollar General Corporation (DG, 19-Sep-2025, USD 102.11), Overweight/Neutral, CD/CE/J

Dollar Tree Inc (DLTR, 19-Sep-2025, USD 95.26), Overweight/Neutral, CD/CE/J

Walmart Inc. (WMT, 19-Sep-2025, USD 102.33), Overweight/Neutral, A/CD/CE/D/E/J/K/L/M/N

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U.S. Broadlines, Hardlines & Food Retail

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AutoZone Inc. (AZO)	Best Buy Co., Inc. (BBY)	Beyond, Inc. (BYON)
BJ's Wholesale Club Holdings, Inc. (BJ)	Costco Wholesale Corp. (COST)	Dollar General Corporation (DG)
Dollar Tree Inc (DLTR)	Driven Brands Holdings Inc. (DRVN)	Five Below, Inc. (FIVE)
Floor & Decor (FND)	Home Depot Inc. (HD)	Kroger Co. (KR)
Lowe's Companies, Inc. (LOW)	O'Reilly Automotive Inc. (ORLY)	RH (RH)
Sprouts Farmers Market Inc (SFM)	Target Corp. (TGT)	Tractor Supply Co. (TSCO)
Walmart Inc. (WMT)	Wayfair Inc. (W)	Williams-Sonoma, Inc. (WSM)

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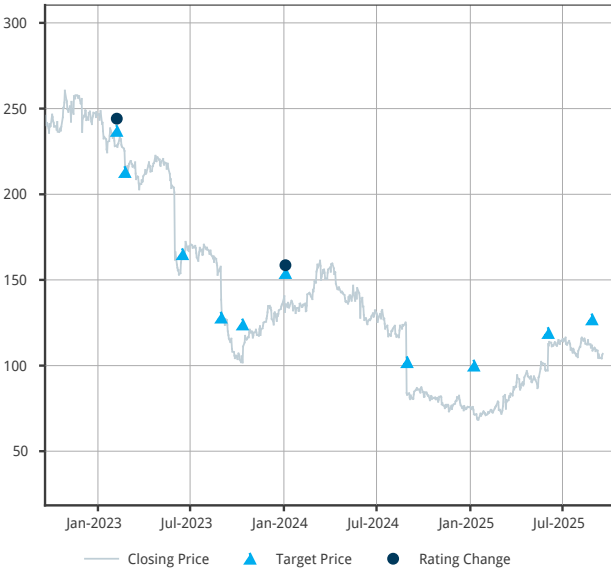
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **NEUTRAL**

Closing Price: **USD 102.11** (19-Sep-2025)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 19-Sep-2025)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

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Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
28-Aug-2025	111.20		127.00
03-Jun-2025	97.17		119.00
08-Jan-2025	74.17		100.00
30-Aug-2024	84.03		102.00
04-Jan-2024	140.43	Overweight	154.00
12-Oct-2023	101.83		124.00
31-Aug-2023	138.50		128.00
16-Jun-2023	163.68		165.00
23-Feb-2023	225.27		213.00
07-Feb-2023	228.39	Equal Weight	237.00

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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Valuation Methodology: Our price target of \$127 is based on 18x our 2026 EPS estimate of \$7.07, as DG's core consumer remains challenged and the promotional environment elevated, partially offset by the company's initiatives to improve operations and remodel stores.

Risks which May Impede the Achievement of the Barclays Research Valuation and Price Target: On the downside: 1) Margin progress is back-end weighted. 2) Competitive dynamics threaten comps and could impact pricing. 3) Operating costs could remain elevated.

Dollar Tree Inc (DLTR / DLTR)

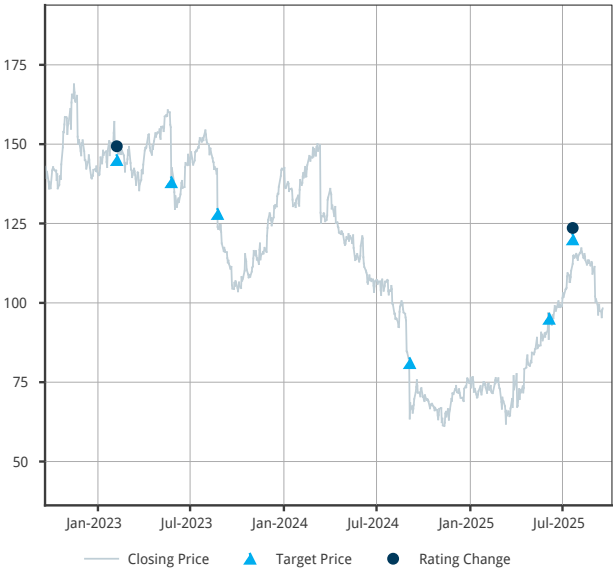
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **NEUTRAL**

Closing Price: **USD 95.26** (19-Sep-2025)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 19-Sep-2025)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

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Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
21-Jul-2025	110.12	Overweight	120.00
05-Jun-2025	88.62		95.00
04-Sep-2024	81.65		81.00
24-Aug-2023	142.22		128.00
25-May-2023	155.35		138.00
07-Feb-2023	150.37	Equal Weight	145.00

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Valuation Methodology: Our \$120 price target is based on 18x our 2026 EPS estimate of \$6.59, which reflects improved sales growth and margin trajectory.

Risks which May Impede the Achievement of the Barclays Research Valuation and Price Target: Cyclical risk, mainly in the discretionary categories, a slowdown in low-income employment, execution risk, and the potential need for more investments in the business.

Walmart Inc. (WMT / WMT)

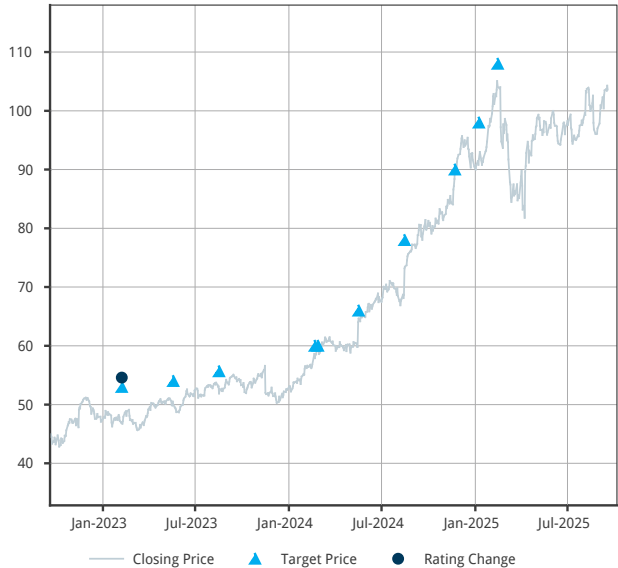
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **NEUTRAL**

Closing Price: **USD 102.33** (19-Sep-2025)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 19-Sep-2025)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

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Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
14-Feb-2025	105.05		108.00
08-Jan-2025	90.81		98.00
22-Nov-2024	88.39		90.00
15-Aug-2024	73.18		78.00
17-May-2024	64.01		66.00
27-Feb-2024	59.60		60.00
21-Feb-2024	57.90		60.00
17-Aug-2023	51.90		55.67
19-May-2023	49.97		54.00
07-Feb-2023	46.99	Overweight	53.00

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Valuation Methodology: Our \$108 price target is based on 37x our FY27E EPS of \$2.90 and is supported by the growing diversity of Walmart's business model and the increasing contribution from sticky high-margin profit drivers that are changing the shape of the model.

Risks which May Impede the Achievement of the Barclays Research Valuation and Price Target: 1) Weak discretionary demand could have a greater impact on its more promotional categories, such as apparel, home, and electronics, and result in markdowns like we saw in prior years. 2) Related to that is mix, which could shift more to staples and have a greater impact on gross margin. 3) A faster slowdown in food inflation would likely weigh on sentiment initially, although we see the potential for elasticity to return across a number of categories as pricing pressures ease.

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